

**AFRICAN WHITE-BACKED VULTURE***Gyps africanus*
F: Accipitridae

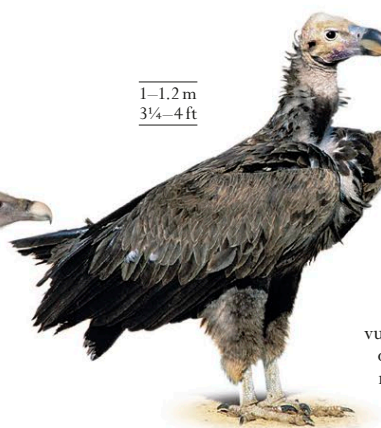
One of the commonest vultures of the sub-Saharan savanna, this species gathers in large numbers near carcasses. These birds are seen in towns and villages.

90–98 cm
35–39 in**EURASIAN GRIFFON***Gyps fulvus*
F: Accipitridae

This vulture occurs in mountainous regions of S.W. Eurasia and N.E. Africa. It breeds and roosts among rocks and on ledges.

neck ruff turns
white with age85–97 cm
34–38 in**RÜPPELL'S VULTURE***Gyps rueppelli*
F: Accipitridae

An African relative of the Eurasian griffon, this darker species inhabits arid areas. It has been recorded as flying at higher altitudes than any other bird.

bulbous
bill1–1.2 m
3¼–4 ft**LAPPET-FACED VULTURE***Torgos tracheliotus*
F: Accipitridae

Like the related *Gyps* vultures, this carrion-eater of arid Africa has a long neck and a bare head to prevent carcasses from soiling its plumage.

1–1.3 m
3¼–4¼ ft**BEARDED VULTURE***Gypaetus barbatus*
F: Accipitridae

Native to the mountains of Africa and Eurasia, this diamond-tailed, solitary vulture subsists largely on marrow obtained by dropping bones on rocks to split them open.

46–56 cm
18–22 in**WHITE HAWK***Pseudastur albicollis*
F: Accipitridae

This forest hawk of C. and S. America hunts for reptiles, especially snakes. It has been described as lethargic and easily approached.

46–51 cm
18–20 in**BLACK-COLLARED HAWK***Buteo lineatus*
F: Accipitridae

A relative of the snail kite, this species occurs in C. and S. American wetlands, where it fishes by dropping feet first into floating vegetation.

36–40 cm
14–16 in**DARK CHANTING GOSHAWK***Melierax metabates*
F: Accipitridae

An African hawk of dry, open country, this bird resembles a harrier when in flight. It has a musical piping call.

60–66 cm
23½–26 in**SNAIL KITE***Rostrhamus sociabilis*
F: Accipitridae

This bird from Florida and C. and S. American marshes has a strongly curved bill, adapted for feeding on aquatic snails.

0.9–1.1 m
3–3½ ft**AFRICAN HARRIER-HAWK***Polyboroides typus*
F: Accipitridae

This raptor from sub-Saharan Africa eats oil-palm fruit and hunts small vertebrates. Its flexible "double-jointed" legs help it take prey from tree-holes.